

GSEB CLASS 10 SOCIAL SCIENCE

Chapter 4: Indian Literature - Section B

SECTION B

Q1. Write about the Sanskrit literature in the medieval period.

- **Development:** Sanskrit literature continued to develop during the medieval period.
- **Important Work:** Jayadeva wrote the famous *Geet Govind*.
- **Shankaracharya:** Adi Shankaracharya wrote Bhashyas and explained Advaita Vedanta.
- **Other Subjects:** Sanskrit works were also written on grammar, drama, law, medicine and astronomy.

Q2. Write a note on Yajurveda.

- **Meaning:** Yajurveda is known as the Veda of yajnas or sacrifices.
- **Form:** It contains both prose and verse forms.
- **Content:** It gives the mantras and procedures used in yajnas and religious rituals.
- **Importance:** It provides information about the ritual practices of ancient India.

Q3. In how many parts is the early Buddhist literature divided?

- **Division:** Early Buddhist literature is divided into three parts, collectively known as the Tripitaka.
- **Vinaya Pitaka:** It contains the rules and discipline for Buddhist monks.
- **Sutta Pitaka:** It contains the teachings and discourses of Buddha.
- **Abhidhamma Pitaka:** It contains philosophical and doctrinal explanations of Buddhism.

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Q4. Write about the Rigveda in brief among the ancient literature.

- **Oldest Veda:** Rigveda is the oldest of the four Vedas and an important ancient Indian literary work.
- **Verses:** It contains 1028 hymns (Richas), divided into 10 Mandalas.
- **Subject:** Many hymns are prayers to gods and natural forces and were used during yajnas.
- **Historical Information:** It gives information about the social, religious and economic life of the Aryans of the Sapt-Sindhu region.

Q5. Which king of Vijayanagar was a lover of literature?

- **King:** Krishnadevaraya was a great lover and patron of literature.
- **Languages:** He encouraged literary activities in Telugu, Kannada and Sanskrit.
- **His Work:** He himself wrote the famous Telugu work *Amuktamalyada*.
- **Contribution:** His reign was an important period of literary and cultural development.

Q6. Where were the famous universities of ancient India? Which Chinese travellers visited these universities?

- **Universities:** Important centres of learning included Takshashila, Nalanda, Vikramshila and Vallabhi.
- **Nalanda:** Nalanda was in Bihar and was visited by the Chinese traveller Xuanzang (Hiuen Tsang).
- **Vallabhi:** Vallabhi was in Gujarat and was visited by Xuanzang and Yijing (I-Tsing).
- **Importance:** Their accounts provide valuable information about the ancient Indian system of education.